

Life in Uni **vs** Real World in Tech.



What uni teaches vs what the real world in tech expects.

FPT edition

Privatus Cosmas

Software Engineer & Digital Innovator, Rohi Company Ltd · Founder, INCPRITECH



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You finished FPT. Give yourselves a round of applause!



Hongera sana!

travel · transport · supervisors... survived

Privatus Cosmas

- Software Engineer & Digital Innovator, Rohi Company Ltd
- Founder, INCPRITECH
- MUST alumnus · Diploma in Computer Science
- First FPT at MUST in 2024. It shaped me.

Nimekaa kiti chako



your brother, not your boss

You stepped out of uni life and tasted real-world tech.

Umeona tofauti?

hands up if work surprised you



UNIVERSITY

Life in Uni

what university teaches you

6 rounds

vs

REAL WORLD

Real World in Tech.

what the real world in tech expects

Tuanze!

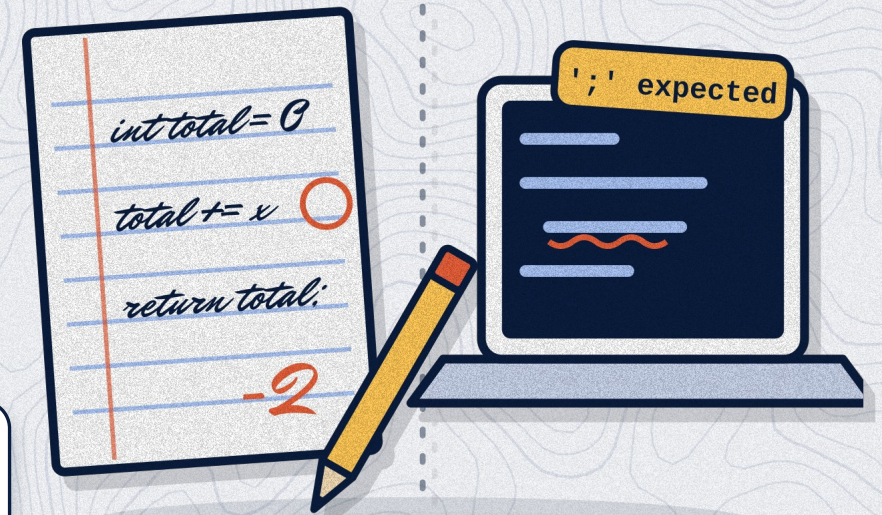
Code on paper vs code on screen.

LIFE IN UNI

Java on paper in the exam.
One missing ; and the marks
are gone.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

**An editor, a linter,
autocomplete. You run the
code fifty times a day.**



01

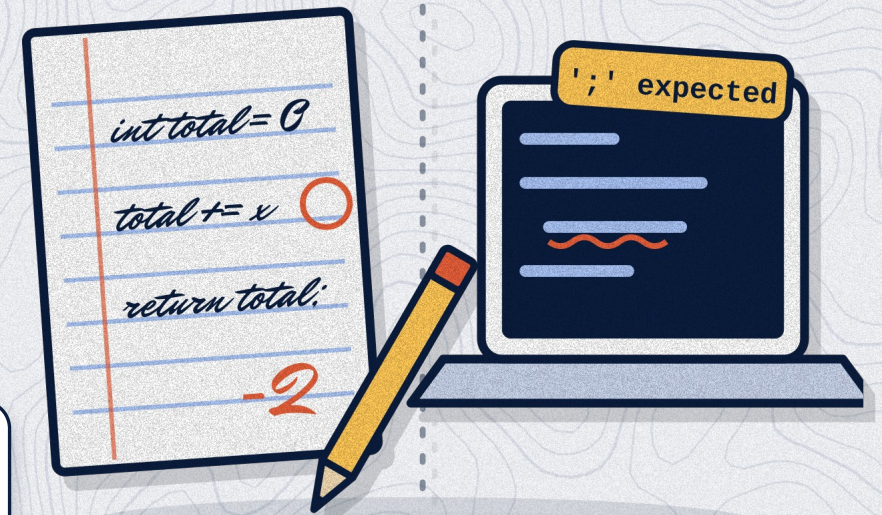
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REAL WORLD IN TECH

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STILL IN SCHOOL? DO THIS

Type your paper code on a computer the same day.

Mantiki kwanza, sintaksia baadaye

Somo

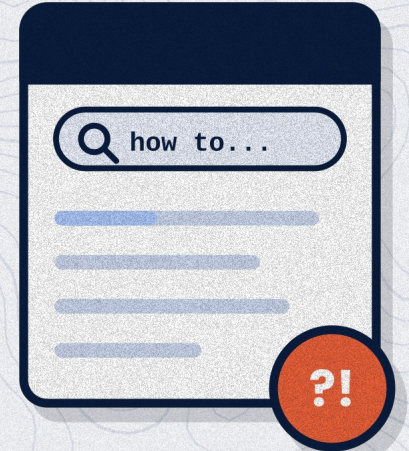
Memorise it vs find it.

LIFE IN UNI

Exams reward cramming definitions word for word.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

Nobody memorises everything. Seniors search, read docs and ask all day.



02

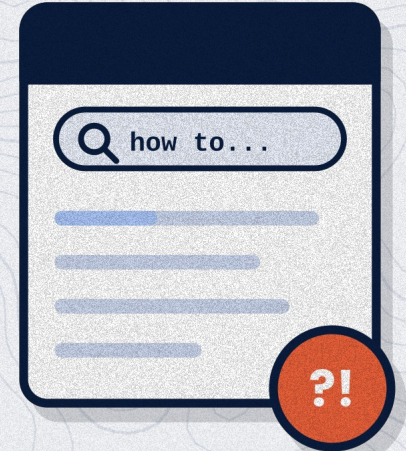
Memorise it vs find it.

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02

Somo

STILL IN SCHOOL? DO THIS

Practise reading official docs, not only notes.

Hakuna anayekariri kila kitu

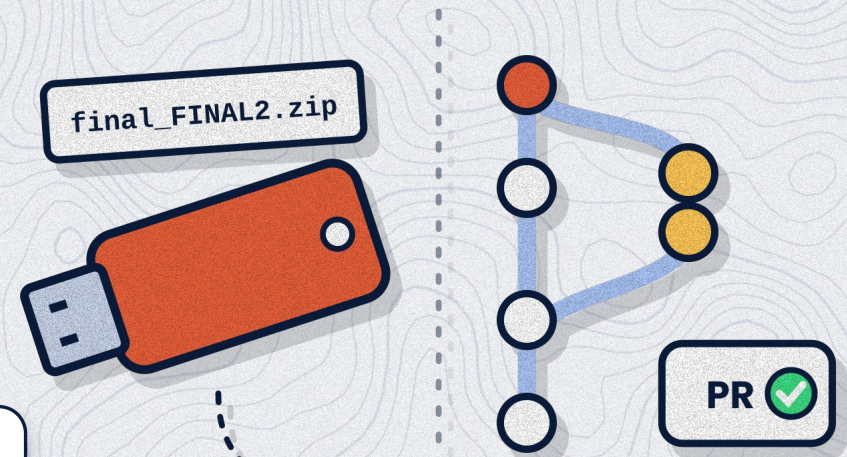
Group work vs teamwork.

LIFE IN UNI

One person does the whole group work. The rest just add their names.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

Everyone ships. Git and code review show exactly who did what.



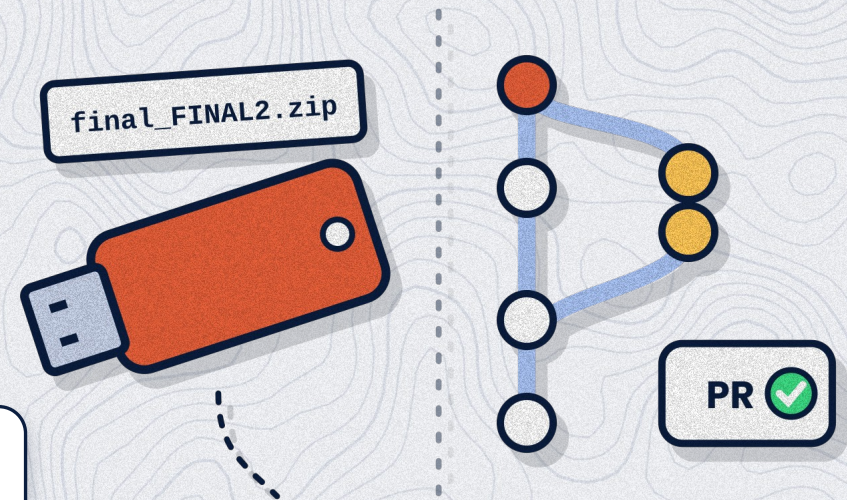
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REAL WORLD IN TECH

Everyone ships. Git and code review show exactly who did what.



STILL IN SCHOOL? DO THIS

Do your part, and put it on GitHub from day one.

Kazi ya kikundi, si ya mtu mmoja

Somo

Toy projects vs real users.

LIFE IN UNI

A calculator. A student system. Your lecturer is the only user.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

Real people, real money, slow networks and every edge case you forgot.



Toy projects vs real users.

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REAL WORLD IN TECH

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STILL IN SCHOOL? DO THIS

Build one thing a real person uses, every semester.

Mteja hasomi code yako

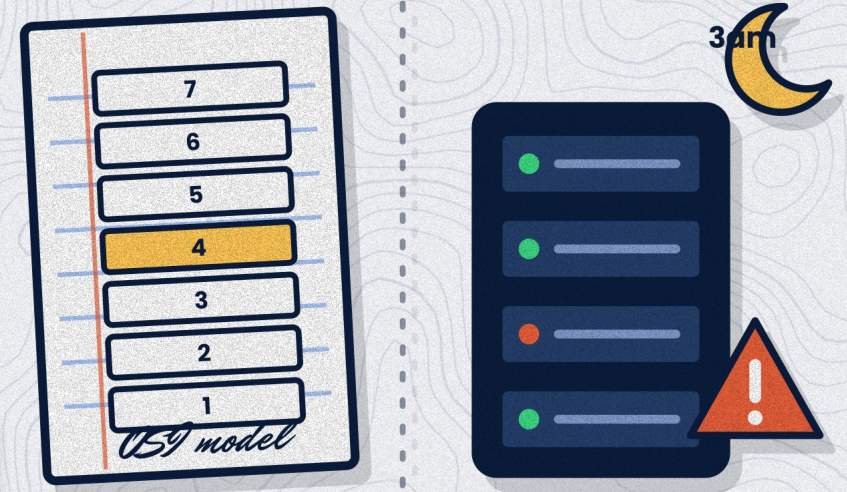
Diagrams vs production.

LIFE IN UNI

Draw the OSI model and the waterfall SDLC for marks.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

**Servers, domains, deploys,
and something breaking at 3
a.m.**



05

Diagrams vs production.

LIFE IN UNI

Draw the OSI model and the waterfall SDLC for marks.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

**Servers, domains, deploys,
and something breaking at 3
a.m.**



STILL IN SCHOOL? DO THIS

Deploy your project online, even on a free tier.

Kwangu inafanya kazi, haitoshi

Somo

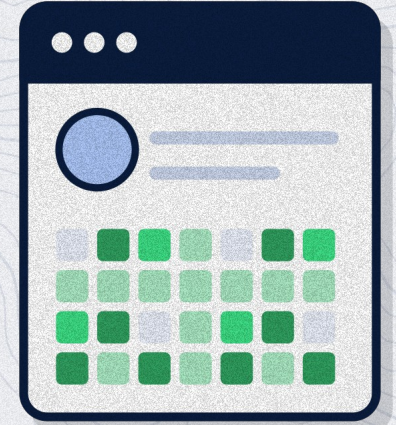
Grades vs GitHub.

LIFE IN UNI

GPA and certificates are the scoreboard.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

"Show me what you've built." I got hired while still a student.



06

Grades vs GitHub.

LIFE IN UNI

GPA and certificates are the scoreboard.

REAL WORLD IN TECH

"Show me what you've built." I got hired while still a student.



06

Somo

STILL IN SCHOOL? DO THIS

Keep three projects you can demo in two minutes.

Vitendo vinaongea zaidi

PART TWO · BACK TO CLASS

Learn it in class.
Prove it in projects.

Bado hujachelewa

02

What did FPT teach you that class never did?

Ulijifunza nini?



Finish strong.

Maliza kwa nguvu

01 Logbook & report

show the skill, not the activity

02 Recommendation letter

thank your supervisor, then ask

03 Keep your contacts

your network is your net worth

04 Collect evidence

photos, screenshots, notes

Not: "I observed the network"

Yes: "I configured 3 switches"

Start now.

Learn it in class. Prove it in projects.

01 Type up your paper code

same day

02 Ship a real project

every semester

03 Live on GitHub

commit, push, repeat

04 Use AI as a tutor

not a copy machine

05 Treat every project like real work

real users, real deadlines

06 Respect the fundamentals

logic, data structures, maths

PART THREE • MONEY

Make money the right way.

Ujuzi ni pesa

03

Your student email is worth millions.

expires when you graduate

GitHub Student Pack

Huawei ICT Academy

Cisco NetAcad

Azure for Students

Microsoft 365

AWS Educate

Microsoft Learn

ALX Africa

Figma · Notion

YouTube / Spotify
Student*

*where available

Claim them this week.

expires when you graduate



01

Activate your uni email

most benefits need it

02

Photo of your student ID

clear and ready to upload

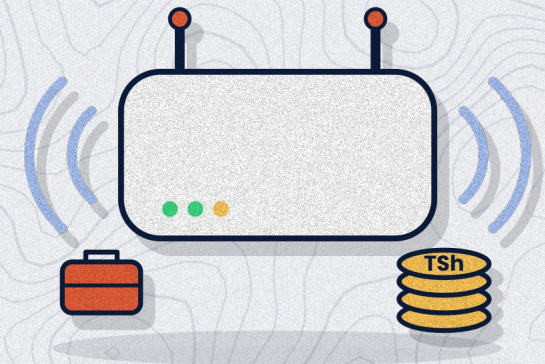
03

Look for “Students”

or “Education” on each site

A gig pays you twice: **money + experience.**

- Repair & software installation
- IT support & network setup
- Websites for local businesses
- Design & social media
- Upwork · Fiverr (once you have work to show)



pay to get a job? = SCAM

Skills get the gig. Reliability keeps it.

01

Start local

friends, family, shops near campus

02

Do the first jobs very well

your reputation is your advert

03

Keep a portfolio

screenshots, photos, thank-yous

04

Be reliable

on time, every time, and talk



pay to get a job? = SCAM

Who knows someone who bets?



no judging, I've been there

Betting. Forex. Crypto.

Know the truth.

red flags

Betting

They make billions because most people lose.

That one win is the trap.

Forex “mentors”

If he makes millions trading, why does he need your 50k?

Gambling with a nicer name.

“Double your money”

Guaranteed profit is almost always a scam.

Learn the tech, keep your fees.

Betting asks:

“How do I get money fast?”

Skills ask:

“How do I become valuable?”

Choose value. Money follows value.

save 10% of everything

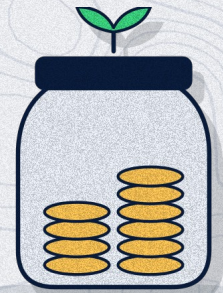
Invest in yourself first.

01 **Never bet money you need**
as a student, that's all of it

02 **Invest in yourself**
a course, a laptop, a skill

03 **Save 10% of everything**
small savings build discipline

04 **Learn first, invest later**
stable income + real knowledge



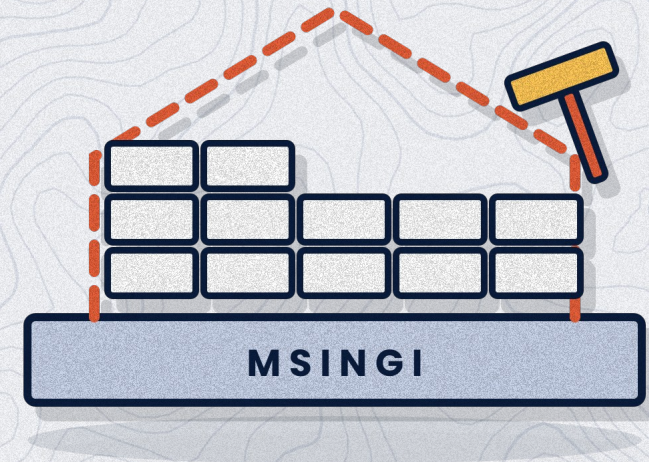
Ask me anything.

Hakuna swali la kijinga



*Shule inakupa msingi,
nyumba unajenga wewe.*

School lays the foundation. You build the house.



ONE LAST TIME, TOGETHER

Your starting point is not your destination.

What you do now shapes it.

Asanteni sana!



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